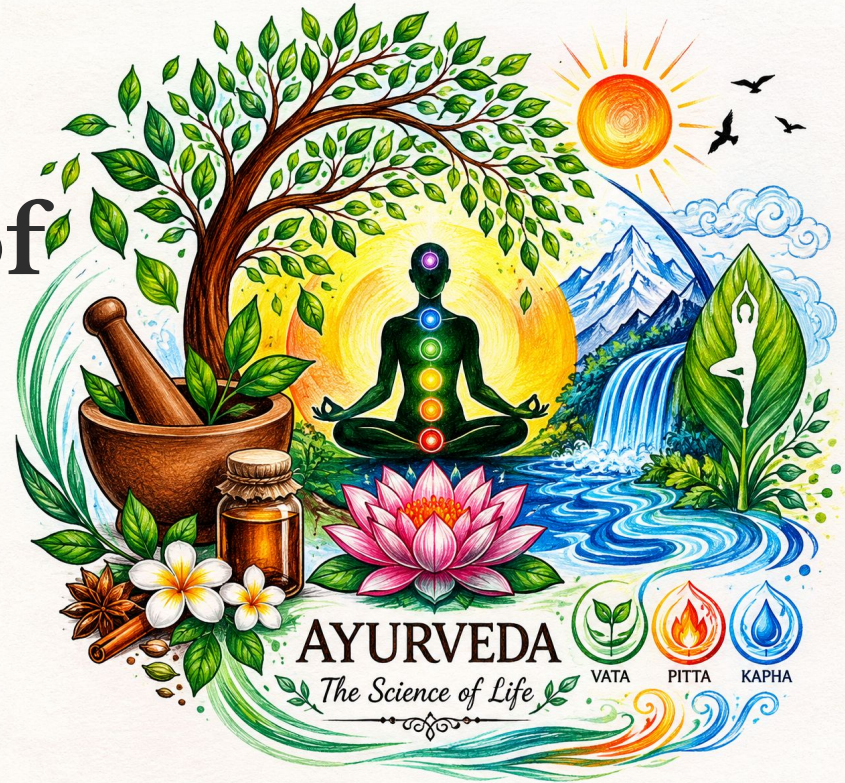


Basic Principles of Ayurveda

Dr. Leena Rajwade.





The Relation of Ayurveda and *Sangeet* (Music)

- निसर्गाशी संलग्न Close to Nature
- अभिजात Elite Class/Artistic
- शाश्वत Eternal /Everlasting
- अपौरुषेय योग-भक्तियोग –Not of Human origin/Divine

शास्त्र कला

- अध्ययन विधि
- Study Method
- Technique
- Guru-Student
- Other factors

Relevant References

- Rajayakshma Chikitsa (Tuberculosis Management) – Hridaya
- Pleasant sights, songs, and harmonious sounds promote well-being and mental peace – Sushruta Samhita
- Care of Pregnant Women and digestive support – Kashyapa Samhita
- Voice and sound abnormalities used as diagnostic indicators – Charaka Samhita, Indriyasthana

ढंगलाचरण

- सहस्राक्षं गणाधीशं स्वगुरुं च सरस्वतीम्।
- जनकं जनयित्रीं च शास्त्रादौ प्रणमाम्यहम्॥(सुश्रुत)
- गुणत्रयविभेदेन मूर्तित्रयमुपेयुषे
- त्रयीभुवे त्रिनेत्राय त्रिलोकीपतये नमः॥(चरक)



Foundational Concepts

Contextualising Ayurveda in Modern Academic Discourse

Common Misconceptions About Ayurveda

- Ayurveda is just a collection of home remedies
- Ayurvedic medicines have no side effects
- Ayurveda works very slowly
- Ayurveda is outdated and not relevant today
- Ayurveda is opposed to modern medicine

- One Ayurvedic treatment works the same for everyone
- Panchakarma is only a massage therapy
- Ayurveda uses only herbal medicines
- Ayurveda is only for treating diseases
- Ayurveda does not include surgery

Reality - Addressing Common Misconceptions

- 1 Ayurveda is a comprehensive healthcare system that includes diagnosis, treatment, preventive care, diet, lifestyle management, rejuvenation therapies, and Panchakarma.
- 2 Any medicine can cause adverse effects if used improperly. Ayurvedic medicines should be taken under the guidance of a qualified Ayurvedic practitioner.
- 3 While chronic conditions may require long-term management, Ayurvedic treatments can provide quick relief in conditions such as indigestion, common cold, and certain types of pain when appropriately prescribed.
- 4 Ayurvedic principles of diet, lifestyle, and preventive healthcare remain relevant and are increasingly being studied through modern research.
- 5 Ayurvedic treatment is highly individualized and is based on factors such as Prakriti (constitution), age, digestive strength, season, and disease condition.
- 6 Ayurveda employs herbal, mineral, and certain animal-derived substances, all processed according to specific classical methods.
- 7 Panchakarma is a specialized detoxification and purification therapy consisting of procedures such as Vamana, Virechana, Basti, Nasya, and Raktamokshana. Massage is only one supportive component.
- 8 Ayurveda and modern medicine have different approaches but can often complement each other when used appropriately and safely.
- 9 The classical text Sushruta Samhita contains detailed descriptions of surgical techniques. Sushruta is often referred to as the "Father of Surgery."
- 10 One of Ayurveda's primary goals is prevention. Its classical objective is: "**Swasthasya Swasthya Rakshanam, Aturasya Vikara Prashamanam**" -To preserve the health of the healthy and to alleviate the diseases of the sick.

What is Ayurveda?

"Ayur" = Life

"Veda" = Knowledge or Science

- Focuses on prevention and maintenance of health
- Treats body, mind, and spirit as one unit

Core Doctrines

Panchamahabhuta · Tridosha · Sapta Dhatu · Mala · Agni

Panchamahabhuta (Five Elements)



Prithvi

Earth



Jala

Water



Agni

Fire



Vayu

Air



Akasha

Ether / Space

All living beings are made of these five elements.

Tridosha Theory - Three Biological Energies

Vata

Movement and
communication

Pitta

Digestion and metabolism

Kapha

Structure and stability

Health = Balance of the three Doshas

Sapta Dhatu (Seven Body Tissues)

1 Rasa (Plasma)

2 Rakta (Blood)

3 Mamsa (Muscle)

4 Meda (Fat)

5 Asthi (Bone)

6 Majja (Bone Marrow / Nervous Tissue)

7 Shukra / Artava (Reproductive Tissue)

Mala (Waste Products)

Purisha

Feces

Mutra

Urine

Sweda

Sweat

Proper elimination is essential for good health.

Agni and Ama

Agni

- Digestive and metabolic fire
- Responsible for digestion and nourishment

Ama

- Undigested toxic material
- Main cause of many diseases

Concept of Health in Ayurveda

According to Ayurveda, a healthy person has:

■ Balanced Doshas

■ Strong Agni

■ Balanced Dhatus

■ Healthy mind, senses, and soul

■ Proper Mala elimination

Dinacharya and Ritucharya

Dinacharya

Daily Regimen

- Early rising
- Exercise
- Healthy diet
- Proper sleep

Ritucharya

Seasonal Regimen

- Lifestyle and diet changes according to seasons

Conclusion -- Basic Principles of Ayurveda

- Holistic approach to health
- Prevention is better than cure
- Individualized treatment
- Balance of body, mind, and spirit

“Swasthasya Swasthya Rakshanam, Aturasya Vikara Prashamanam.”

(To maintain the health of the healthy and to cure the diseased.)

Five Types of Vayu in Ayurveda

Applied Aspects

Introduction -- Pancha Vayu

Vata Dosha is the principle of movement. It is divided into five functional subtypes:

Prana Vayu

Udana Vayu

Samana Vayu

Vyana Vayu

Apana Vayu

Balanced Pancha Vayu is essential for maintaining health.

Prana Vayu

Location

- Head
- Brain
- Chest

Functions

- Respiration
- Swallowing
- Perception through sense organs
- Mental activities

Applied Aspect

- Pranayama and meditation
- Management of anxiety and stress
- Neurological and respiratory health

Udana Vayu

Location

- Chest
- Throat
- Nose

Functions

- Speech
- Memory
- Enthusiasm and energy
- Upward movements

Applied Aspect

- Voice disorders
- Public speaking and communication
- Respiratory rehabilitation

Samana Vayu

Location

- Stomach
- Small intestine
- Region near Agni

Functions

- Digestion
- Absorption of nutrients
- Separation of useful and waste products

Applied Aspect

- Digestive disorders
- Improving metabolism
- Enhancing nutrient absorption

Vyana Vayu

Location

- Distributed throughout the body

Functions

- Blood circulation
- Movement of muscles and joints
- Coordination of body activities

Applied Aspect

- Cardiovascular health
- Physical exercise and sports medicine
- Neuromuscular coordination

Apana Vayu

Location

- Pelvic region
- Colon
- Bladder
- Reproductive organs

Functions

- Urination
- Defecation
- Menstruation
- Childbirth
- Ejaculation

Applied Aspect

- Constipation management
- Reproductive health
- Obstetrics and gynecology
- Urinary disorders

Clinical Importance -- Effects of Vayu Imbalance

Vayu	Common Disorders
Prana	Anxiety, breathing disorders
Udana	Speech problems, hoarseness
Samana	Indigestion, malabsorption
Vyana	Poor circulation, body pain
Apana	Constipation, menstrual disorders

Management of Pancha Vayu

- Balanced diet
- Regular exercise
- Yoga and Pranayama
- Proper sleep
- Panchakarma therapies
- Ayurvedic medicines as indicated

Conclusion -- Applied Significance of Pancha Vayu

- Regulates all physiological activities
- Maintains physical and mental health
- Helps in disease prevention
- Forms the basis for Ayurvedic diagnosis and treatment

“Vata is the driving force behind all bodily functions.”

Mind in Ayurveda

Understanding Mental Health Through Ancient Wisdom

Introduction

- Ayurveda = "Science of Life"
- Ancient healthcare system from India
- Focuses on balance of:

Body

Mind

Spirit

Goal: Health, happiness, and longevity

Importance of the Mind

- Mind influences thoughts, emotions, and behavior
- Mental health affects physical health
- Ayurveda considers mind and body inseparable

“A healthy mind supports a healthy body.”

What is Mind (Manas) in Ayurveda?

Mind is called “MANAS” in Ayurveda.

Acts as a bridge between:

Sense organs

Body

Soul (Atma)

Functions:

- Thinking
- Feeling
- Decision-making
- Memory

Functions of the Mind

Core Functions

- Perception
- Attention
- Thinking
- Memory
- Emotions
- Decision-making

Examples

- Learning
- Problem solving
- Managing emotions

Three Mental Qualities (Triguna)

Sattva

- Calm
- Clear
- Positive
- Balanced

Rajas

- Activity
- Desire
- Restlessness

Tamas

- Inertia
- Laziness
- Confusion

Understanding Triguna

Sattva	Rajas	Tamas
Peace	Agitation	Dullness
Wisdom	Impulsiveness	Ignorance
Harmony	Competition	Inactivity

Healthy mind = Predominantly Sattvic

Mind and Doshas

Vata

- Anxiety
- Fear
- Worry

Pitta

- Anger
- Irritability
- Perfectionism

Kapha

- Attachment
- Sadness
- Lack of motivation

Signs of a Healthy Mind

✓ Positive thinking

✓ Emotional stability

✓ Good memory

✓ Self-control

✓ Compassion

✓ Ability to handle stress

Causes of Mental Imbalance

- Poor lifestyle
- Lack of sleep
- Stress
- Unhealthy diet
- Negative emotions
- Excessive screen time
- Lack of social connection

Ayurvedic Approaches for Mental Well-being

Ahara (Diet)

- Fresh, wholesome foods

Vihara (Lifestyle)

- Exercise
- Daily routine

Nidra

- Adequate sleep

Meditation

- Mental relaxation

Foods That Support Mental Health

Recommended

- Fresh fruits
- Vegetables
- Nuts and seeds
- Milk (if tolerated)
- Whole grains

Limit

- Excess junk food
- Excess caffeine
- Excess alcohol

Meditation and Yoga

Benefits

- Reduces stress
- Improves concentration
- Enhances emotional balance
- Promotes inner peace

Simple Practices

- Deep breathing
- Mindfulness
- Gentle yoga

Daily Tips for a Healthy Mind

Wake up at a regular time

Sleep 7–8 hours

Practice gratitude

Spend time in nature

Exercise daily

Limit digital overload

Eat mindfully

Key Takeaways

- Mind (Manas) is central to health in Ayurveda.
- Sattva, Rajas, and Tamas influence mental state.
- Balanced lifestyle promotes mental well-being.
- Ayurveda emphasizes prevention and harmony.

“Health is a state of balance between body, mind, and spirit.”

Philosophy of Knowledge

Dhee · Dhairya · Atmadi Vijnana · Shabda Pramāṇa

Dhee, Dhairya, Atmadi Vijnana: The Supreme Medicine for the Mind

"धी धैर्यात्मादि विज्ञानं मनोदोषौषधं परम्"

Dhee

Wisdom / Right Understanding

- Ability to think clearly
- Correct judgment and discrimination
- Understanding what is beneficial and harmful

Dhairya

Courage / Mental Strength

- Emotional resilience
- Patience during difficulties
- Ability to control impulses and negative emotions

Atmadi Vijnana

Self-Knowledge

- Understanding oneself
- Awareness of one's thoughts, emotions, and actions
- Spiritual insight and self-reflection

Relevance Today: Mindfulness and self-awareness · Positive thinking · Stress management · Emotional intelligence · Mental well-being

Shabda Pramāṇa (Verbal Testimony)

In Indian philosophy and Ayurveda, **Pramāṇa** means a reliable way of gaining knowledge. **Shabda Pramāṇa** is knowledge obtained through the definition.

Definition

- Shabda = Word, speech, or testimony
- Pramāṇa = Means of valid knowledge

Key Source

Knowledge from a trustworthy person or authoritative source.

Importance of Shabda Pramāṇ in Ayurveda

In Ayurveda

Ayurveda gives great importance to the teachings of ancient sages and classical texts such as:

- Charaka Samhita
- Sushruta Samhita
- Ashtanga Hridaya

*Knowledge obtained from these authoritative texts is considered a form of **Shabda Pramāṇa**.*

Why Is It Important?

Many things cannot be known directly through our senses or personal experience. We depend on experts and authentic texts for such knowledge. Shabda Pramāṇa helps us learn:

- History
- Geography
- Scientific discoveries
- Medical knowledge
- Spiritual teachings

शान्तिमंत्र

•
ॐ द्यौः शान्तिरन्तरिक्षं शान्तिः पृथिवी शान्तिरापः शान्तिरोषधयः शान्तिः ।
वनस्पतयः शान्तिर्विश्वेदेवाः शान्तिर्ब्रह्म शान्तिः सर्वं शान्तिः शान्तिरेव शान्तिः सा मा
शान्तिरेधि ॥
ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

